

How To Add PPA Repository Manually Without "add-apt-repository" On Ubuntu

Written on: Aug 17, 2017 by zackad

The easiest way to adding ppa (Personal Package Archive) into ubuntu (and it's variant) repository is to use `add-apt-repository`. Unfortunately this tool sometime is not installed in the system especially on minimalist distribution such as docker image. The good news is, we can add it manually.

Step 1 — Adding PPA link to source list

Visit [ppa](#) to search witch ppa we want to add to our system. Use the search menu to find the ppa we want.



Open the page and click **Technical details about this PPA** to show ppa url and gpg key.

Adding this PPA to your system

You can update your system with unsupported packages from this untrusted PPA by adding **ppa:certbot/certbot** to your system's Software Sources. ([Read about installing](#))

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:certbot/certbot
sudo apt-get update
```

Technical details about this PPA

This PPA can be added to your system manually by copying the lines below and adding them to your system's software sources.

Display sources.list entries for: **Xenial (16.04)**

```
deb http://ppa.launchpad.net/certbot/certbot/ubuntu xenial main
deb-src http://ppa.launchpad.net/certbot/certbot/ubuntu xenial main
```

Signing key:

4096R/75BCA694 ([What is this?](#))

Fingerprint:

7BF576066ADA65728FC7E70A8C47BE8E75BCA694

For questions and bugs with software in this PPA please contact [certbot](#).

Open file `/etc/apt/source.list` and add the url we get from ppa page to the bottom of the file. in this example

```
...
# certbot source package to generate letsencrypt ssl certificate
deb http://ppa.launchpad.net/certbot/certbot/ubuntu xenial main
deb-src http://ppa.launchpad.net/certbot/certbot/ubuntu xenial main
```

Step 2 — Import GPG Key

Now we need to install gpg key. Back to ppa webpage, find the signing key that look like **4096R/75BCA694 (What is this?)**. Copy the portion after the slash but not including the help link; e.g. just **75BCA694**.

Open the terminal and type this command

```
sudo apt-key adv --keyserver keyserver.ubuntu.com --recv-keys 75BCA694
```

Step 3 — Update package list

If gpg key successfully installed we can update our package list using command

```
sudo apt-get update
```

To install certbot package after ppa is added, we can use this command

```
sudo apt-get install certbot
```

Conclusion

Now we can adding ppa source package to our source list without using command `add-apt-repository`. All we need to do is add

ppa url to *source.list* and import gpg key signed by ppa package maintainer.

Reference

- <https://askubuntu.com/a/38029/562900>

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Got it!